THE LETTER TO THE FATHER

Sales & Distribution Brief

The Buy

A prestige feature built around a clean acquisition proposition: **Adrien Brody as Franz Kafka** in a role with obvious awards heat, a culturally legible title, and stronger propulsion than the usual literary-biopic lane. The film is structured in six movements but sells simply: a brilliant son can describe every system except the one that formed him. The recurring office case, the undelivered father letter, and the late Berlin movement with Dora give buyers a movie that is marketable as drama, not homework.

Why It Is More Accessible Than the Subject Suggests

This is not a museum-piece writer portrait. The office material gives the first half procedural traction. The Felice/Milena/Dora architecture gives the middle and back half emotional variety. The father-letter engine gives the campaign a memorable trailer spine and title hook. Even for audiences who have never read Kafka, the movie plays as pressure, shame, love, illness, and the cost of remaining undelivered to the people closest to you.

Acquisition Thesis

Brody provides the package's immediate value and campaign logic. Kafka provides worldwide cultural recognition. The script's differentiator is that it turns those assets into a tighter dramatic object than most prestige-biographical comps: a role with six major clip scenes, a rigorous formal concept, and a final movement that lands with warmth before collapse. It fits the exact space where specialty distributors, prestige streamers, and international sales agents still want films that can open on reviews, festivals, performance, and cultural conversation.

Launch Path

Primary launch thesis: Venice Competition, then Telluride/TIFF, then fall platform release. Cannes is viable if a director from the current target tier lands. The movie wants discovery through curation, then a campaign framed around Brody, the role's physical and emotional demands, and the unusual clarity of the father-letter premise.

Audience & Territory Fit

Core audience: upscale arthouse, prestige-adult drama, awards-season viewers, literary/cultural audience, and Brody-driven specialty crowd. Strongest international territories are German-speaking Europe, France, Italy, the UK, and urban North America. The package also travels well to prestige streaming because the concept can be summarized in one sentence and the campaign story is instantly legible.

Marketing Hooks

Campaign line: the definitive Kafka performance. — *Trailer engine*: the man who could write the Letter to His Father but never deliver it. — *Visuals*: the office machine, tribunal-like family scenes, the returned Letter in Berlin, Brod's "burn everything" confrontation, the final handwritten slips. — *Positioning*: *The Brutalist* credibility with a cleaner emotional hook and a more classical prestige-release shape.

Comparable Landing Zone

Searchlight, Focus, Sony Pictures Classics, MUBI, or a top-tier streamer awards play. The film can support either a disciplined platform theatrical campaign or a premium acquisition with festival-and-awards value as the primary driver.

A prestige acquisition with a clear title hook, a real performance event, and a cleaner sales story than the genre usually offers.

Development example. All casting, financing and awards language is illustrative; no attachments confirmed.